EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEW

‘FOR INDIA, WE ARE READY TO REVIVE THE CHABAHAR PORT’



IANS

On his visit to India to attend the BRICS summit on September 12-13, DR MASOUD PEZESHKIAN, president of the Islamic Republic of Iran, gave an exclusive interview to INDIA TODAY Group Editor, Foreign Affairs, GEETA MOHAN, answering a wide range of questions, including his ties with India, the ongoing conflict with the US, the nuclear weapons issue and the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz. Excerpts:

Q. What was the focal point of the discussion in your bilateral meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi?

Since assuming office, relations with your prime minister have been getting better. India and Iran have deep cultural relations and a long history for several millennia, and this is not something that would change. We are trying to build on this so that we can help each other counter the totalitarianism that is developing in the world.

Q. India has strategic interests in Iran, like Chabahar port. How viable do you think Chabahar is for India, especially amid the regional conflict?

We did not start the war—they [Israel